

HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Analyze the following two primary source excerpts and construct a document-based argument about the contradictions African Americans faced during World War II and how those contradictions shaped postwar civil rights activism.

US.51 — Identify the roles and sacrifices of individual American soldiers, as well as the unique contributions of special fighting forces such as the Tuskegee Airmen, the 442nd Regimental Combat team, and the Navajo Code Talkers.

US.52 — Examine the impact of World War II on economic and social conditions for African Americans, including the Fair Employment Practices Committee and the eventual integration of the armed forces by President Harry S. Truman. (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006)

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document A

Excerpt from the Executive Order 8802, President Franklin D. Roosevelt, June 25, 1941 (Federal Register, Vol. 6, No. 125, June 25, 1941; National Archives, [archives.gov](https://www.archives.gov))

“We call upon the President and Congress to declare racial democracy here at home as our war aim, even as we fight for democracy abroad... We have a stake in this fight — we are Americans. But we must have a victory at home as well as abroad. The first V is for victory over our enemies from without; the second V is for victory over our enemies from within.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document B

Excerpt from Executive Order 9981, issued by President Harry S. Truman, July 26, 1948 (Federal Register, 1948; National Archives, public domain)

“There shall be equality of treatment and opportunity for all persons in the armed services without regard to race, color, religion, or national origin. This policy shall be put into effect as rapidly as possible, having due regard to the time required to effectuate any necessary changes without impairing efficiency or morale.””

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or
hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make
the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how
does that shape it?

The question

Using HIPP analysis for each document and your knowledge of African Americans' experiences during and after World War II, construct an argument that traces the relationship between Executive Order 8802 and the Fair Employment Practices Committee's wartime demands (Document A) and Truman's desegregation order (Document B). Your argument must evaluate: whether EO 9981 represented a fulfillment of the Double V's goals, the limitations of the order, and how WWII service shaped the civil rights generation of the 1950s and 1960s. Include at least two pieces of outside evidence.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document A		
Document B		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

